# NEWSBEATS

*Your daily news, in a hit song.*

Pre-Seed Round · Raising £1M–£1.5M

newsbeats.vercel.app

April 2026

THE PROBLEM

# Gen Z stopped reading the news.

*But they never stopped wanting to know what's happening.*

**67%**

decline in newspaper circulation since 1990

**39%**

of people actively avoid the news (Reuters 2025)

**54%**

of under-35s get news from social/audio first

## The problem isn't apathy. It's format.

Gen Z spends 4+ hours daily inside audio and social apps. They don't have time to read articles — they need information delivered in the formats they already live in: audio, rhythm, and music.

THE SOLUTION

# We don't read you the news. We play it.

## STEP 01

### You pick your topics

Choose World, Business, Sports, Tech and more. Select your genre: Hip-Hop, Pop, Jazz, EDM, Reggaeton, R&B.

## STEP 02

### AI does everything

We fetch today's real headlines, write lyrics packed with facts, and generate a full song via AI — all in under 60 seconds.

## STEP 03

### You listen and share

A fresh 2–6 min song every day. Today's news, sung. No reading. No scrolling. No skipping.

*"It's Friday the 4th of April — let me break down the world..." — AI-generated Hip-Hop beat based on today's real headlines*

THE PRODUCT

# NewsBeats — Live at newsbeats.vercel.app

### 6 languages

EN, FR, ES, DE, PT, IT — lyrics generated and sung in your language

### Flash & Deep Dive

2-min Flash (5 stories) or 6-min Deep Dive (15 stories)

### 6 music genres

Hip-Hop, Pop, Reggaeton, R&B, Afrobeat, EDM

### Real AI pipeline

Claude AI writes lyrics · ACE-Step sings them · Cloudflare stores them

### 8 news topics

World, Business, Tech, Politics, Science, Sports, Entertainment, Health

### Date-anchored

Every song opens: "It's Friday the 4th of April..." — grounded in today

Tech stack: Claude API · ACE-Step / Replicate · Cloudflare R2 · Upstash Redis · Next.js · Vercel · Guardian API

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

# A $177B convergence.

| TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET | SERVICEABLE ADDRESSABLE MARKET | SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE MARKET |
|---|---|---|
| **$177B** | **$11B** | **$30M** |
| Podcast + Music Streaming + AI Music by 2030 | Audio news + AI-generated music English-speaking markets | 350K–1M active users Year 3 target at $2.50 ARPU |

- Podcast market: $131B by 2030 · 27% CAGR (Grand View Research)
- Music streaming: $108B by 2030 · 14.9% CAGR (Grand View Research)
- AI Music: $3B by 2030 · 30% CAGR (Spherical Insights)
- 547M global podcast listeners in 2024 → 619M by 2026

WHY NOW

# Three forces converging in 2026.

## 01

### Gen Z has gone audio-native

- 75% of Gen Z adults listen to podcasts (2025)
- 63% of Americans 13–24 are monthly podcast listeners
- 54% of under-35s: social/audio is their primary news source
- News avoidance hit a record 39% globally (Reuters DNR 2025)

## 02

### AI music has reached commercial grade

- Suno: $2.45B valuation · 100M users · 7M tracks/day
- ElevenLabs: $11B valuation · $500M Series D · Feb 2026
- ACE-Step 1.5: generates full songs in under 2 seconds
- Apple acquired audio AI startup for $2B · Feb 2026

## 03

### Native audio ads are exploding

- Audio gets 2.7 hrs/day of attention but only 4.5% of ad spend
- Podcast ad CPMs: $21–28 vs display $5–15
- Native ad market: $130B growing at 12% CAGR
- AI-personalized audio ads: +22pp brand favorability lift

BUSINESS MODEL

# Three revenue streams. One platform.

## Freemium Subscription

- Free tier: 1 song/day · ads supported
- Premium £4.99/mo: unlimited · ad-free · offline · personalisation
- 3–8% conversion · Spotify benchmarks 40% at maturity

REVENUE TARGET

**£350K–£1.2M ARR at 50K–100K MAUs**

## Native Brand Beats

- Brands sponsor a news topic or genre
- AI weaves their sonic identity into the beat contextually — not an ad break, part of the song
- £30–50 CPM · 3–5x premium over standard audio ads

REVENUE TARGET

**£200K–£800K ARR with 5–10 brand partners**

## B2B Licensing

- White-label the engine to media companies, radio groups, publishers
- They get their own branded "news beat" product. We provide the AI pipeline.
- iHeart · BBC · Spotify · publishers seeking Gen Z formats

REVENUE TARGET

**£500K–£2M ARR at 3–5 enterprise clients**

MONETISATION INNOVATION

# The ad IS the beat.

*A patentable, first-of-its-kind advertising format.*

## How it works

1. Advertiser provides: brand name, message, sonic identity, target topics
2. AI matches news context to brand brief (e.g. Trump exits war → Guide du Routard)
3. Claude writes a lyric line that references the brand naturally and humorously
4. The beat is generated with the brand reference woven into the song itself
5. User hears a great song — brand gets context-perfect, frictionless placement
6. A small ✦ icon marks the sponsored line — legally compliant, visually minimal

### Example lyric placement

*"Trump's looking for the exit ramp, maybe check the Routard map..." ✦*

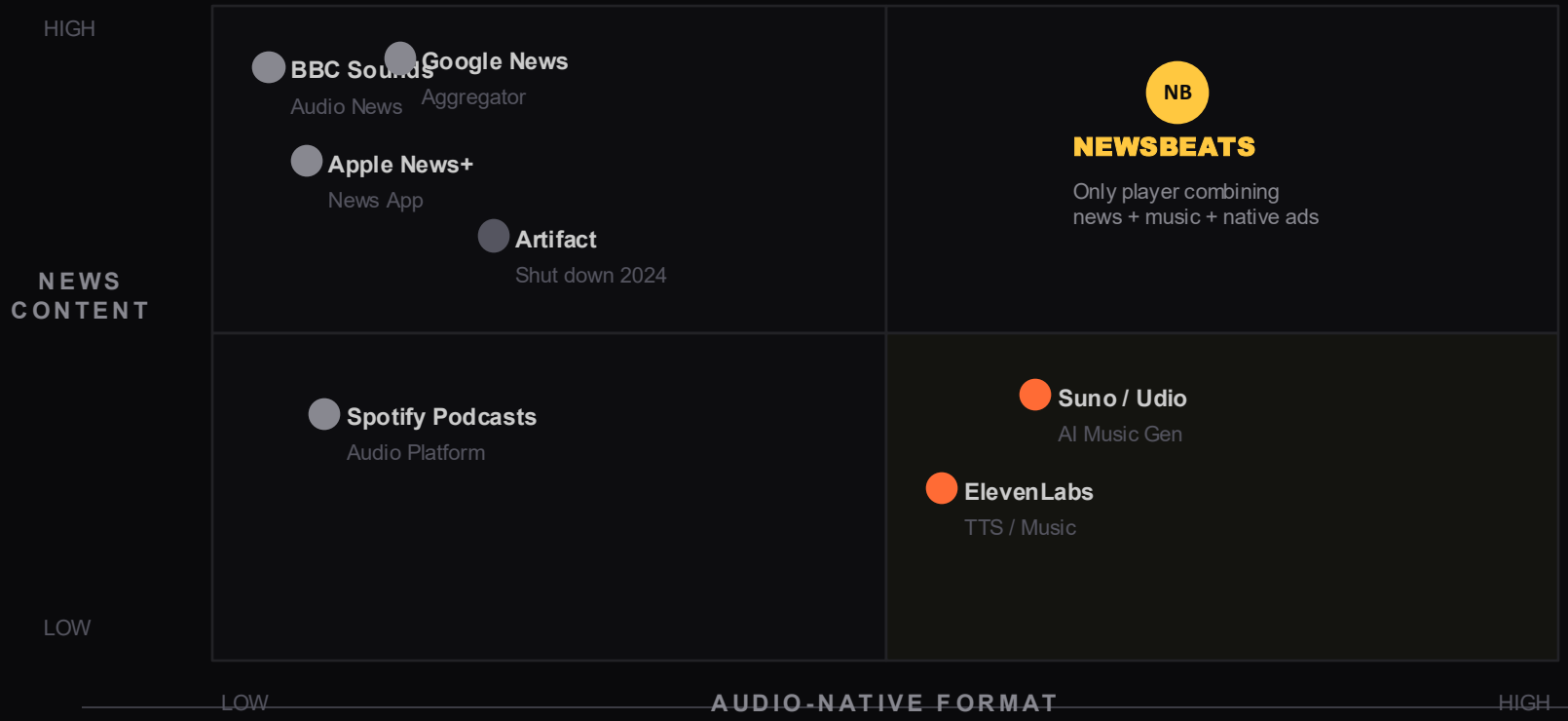
### Why it wins vs. standard audio ads

✓ Zero skip rate — user hears it as content
✓ +22pp brand favorability (AI-personalised audio)
✓ Context-matched placement: 75% higher recall
✓ £30–50 CPM vs £5–15 standard display

Audio captures only 4.5% of ad spend despite 2h42m of daily listening · Native ad market: $130B growing 12% annually (Grand View Research, 2024)

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

# Nobody does what we do.




**KEY INSIGHT**

No competitor combines:

- Real-time news
- AI-generated music
- Lyrics users can hear sung
- Native brand integration

TRACTION & VALIDATION

# Built and live. Fast.

**Feb 2026**

### Concept validated

Identified white space at intersection of AI music + news consumption

**Mar 2026**

### MVP built

Full pipeline: real news → AI lyrics → AI-generated sung song. App live.

**Apr 2026**

### Public beta

newsbeats.vercel.app — 6 languages, 6 genres, 8 topics, Flash + Deep Dive modes

**Now**

### Raising pre-seed

Seeking £1–1.5M to scale product, acquire users, launch native ad pilots

## Key proof points

✓ Full AI pipeline operational — real news to sung song in <90 seconds

✓ Smart caching: same combo served to unlimited users at ~zero marginal cost

✓ 6 languages + 6 genres validated with test users

✓ ACE-Step API: $0.015/song — unit economics proven at scale

UNIT ECONOMICS

# Designed to scale near zero marginal cost.

## Cost per song generated

| | |
|---|---|
| ACE-Step via Replicate | $0.015 |
| Claude API (lyrics) | $0.003 |
| Guardian API (news) | $0.000 |
| Cloudflare R2 (storage) | $0.001 |
| Other infra (Redis, Vercel) | $0.001 |
| **TOTAL COST PER SONG** | **~$0.020** |

## The cache multiplier

Same combo (e.g. EN+HipHop+Flash+World/Business) generated ONCE — served to unlimited users at zero extra cost. 1,000 users requesting the same beat = 1 API call, not 1,000.

**Real cost at 100K users: ~$200/month in API costs**

## Revenue vs. cost at scale

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 100K users, 3% premium | £15K/mo | 99% |
| 5 brand partners @ £5K/mo | £25K/mo | >95% |
| 2 B2B licences @ £10K/mo | £20K/mo | >95% |

GO-TO-MARKET

# Launch fast. Own the format.

| PHASE 1 · Months 1–6 | PHASE 2 · Months 6–12 | PHASE 3 · Months 12–18 |
|---|---|---|
| **Beachhead: English-speaking Gen** | **Expand + Monetise** | **B2B + Seed raise** |
| Target: 18–28 year olds, UK + US | Launch in FR, ES, DE — same product, localised content | Pitch first B2B licence to radio group or publisher |
| Channel: TikTok + Instagram Reels — post daily news beats, let virality do the work | First 3–5 brand beat pilot campaigns | Scale native ad programme to 10+ brands |
| Creator partnerships: pay 10 news creators to share their daily beat | Premium subscription launch | Raise £3–5M seed at £20–30M valuation |
| Product hunt + app store launch | Campus ambassador programme (UK universities) | Target: 100K–200K MAUs |
| Target: 10,000 MAUs | Target: 50,000 MAUs · First revenue | ARR target: £1–2M |

STRATEGIC UPSIDE

# Built to grow. Positioned to exit.

**Apple acquired Q.ai (audio AI startup) for $2 billion — Feb 2026. Its biggest deal since Beats.**

*This signals that major tech and media companies view audio AI as core strategic infrastructure worth paying for.*

## Tech Giants

*Spotify · Apple · Google*
Gen Z audio attention + native AI music format = core platform play. Spotify has 751M MAUs and is racing to differentiate from Apple Music.

## Radio & Broadcast Groups

*iHeart · Global · Bauer*
iHeart generated $1.1B in podcast revenue in 2024 but faces digital migration. NewsBeats is the AI-native format they can't build internally fast enough.

## News & Media Publishers

*Guardian · BBC · Axel Springer*
Publishers are desperate to reach Gen Z. A music-native news format paired with licensed content solves their biggest distribution problem.

## Adtech & Social Platforms

*Meta · ByteDance · Snap*
The native brand beat format is a genuinely new ad product with measurable performance. An acquisition gives them defensible audio-native advertising IP.

Suno: $2.45B valuation · ElevenLabs: $11B valuation · Comparable AI/audio transactions signal strong appetite for category consolidation

THE TEAM

# Founder-market fit.

G

## Guillaume Limouzineau

Founder & CEO · London, UK

🏢 Banking executive at MUFG — Corporate Advisory & Transaction Execution (Healthcare & Utilities)

🎓 EDHEC Business School (Grande École)

🌍 French-British, multilingual (EN, FR, ES) — deep understanding of multi-market product needs

💡 Serial side-project builder: 2 published book series on Amazon KDP, multiple app concepts validated

### Why this founder owns this market

Finance professional who understands monetisation, multi-market expansion, and how to pitch institutional investors. Multilingual by default. Built the working MVP himself using AI tools. Knows what it means to be time-poor and news-hungry.

### First hires (post-raise)

→ CTO / Full-stack AI engineer
→ Growth lead (audio/social media native)
→ Partnerships lead (brands + media)

ROADMAP & FINANCIALS

# 18 months to seed-ready.

| | Q2 2026 | Q3 2026 | Q4 2026 | Q1 2027 | Q2 2027 | Q3 2027 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Product | Beta live | Native ads + premium | | B2B API + personalisation | | |
| Users | 0 → 10K MAU | | 10K → 50K MAU | | 50K → 200K MAU | |
| Revenue | | First £ | £50K–200K ARR | | £500K–2M ARR | |
| Fundraising | Pre-seed close | | | | | Seed raise |

## Use of funds — £1.25M raise

**Product & Engineering (45%) — £560K**
CTO hire, AI pipeline improvements, iOS/Android apps

**Growth & Marketing (35%) — £440K**
Creator partnerships, paid social, brand deal team

**Operations & Legal (20%) — £250K**
Team, admin, IP protection, compliance

BETA vs. FINAL PRODUCT

# Where we are. Where we're going.

## ⚡ BETA — Live now

- ✓ Web app live — newsbeats.vercel.app
- ✓ 6 languages · 6 genres · 8 topics
- ✓ Flash (2 min) + Deep Dive (6 min)
- ✓ Real Guardian API news headlines
- ✓ Claude AI lyrics — fact-dense, date-anchored
- ✓ ACE-Step AI sings the lyrics (not TTS)
- ✓ Cloudflare R2 + Redis smart caching
- ✓ Daily combo cache — scales to 1M users free
- ○ No daily cap — unlimited generation

## 🚀 FINAL PRODUCT — Post-raise

- iOS + Android native apps
- Suno API integration for higher vocal quality
- Personalised recommendations (user history)
- Daily notification — "Your beat is ready"
- Social sharing with branded waveform card
- Premium subscription (ad-free, offline)
- Native brand beat ad system (live pilots)
- Themes: Chill, Hype, Lo-Fi, Acoustic versions
- Extended topics: Climate, Finance, Crypto, Culture

On Suno: Suno API ($0.03/song) produces higher-quality vocals vs ACE-Step ($0.015). Post-raise we switch to Suno once scale justifies the 2x cost premium.

ITERATIONS & EXPANSION

# Every axis is an expansion lever.

## 🎨 Music Themes

→ Chill / Lo-Fi version — relaxed tempo, study music
→ Hype / Club version — 140 BPM, festival energy
→ Acoustic version — guitar, stripped back
→ Classical version — orchestral news delivery
→ K-Pop, Bossa Nova, Country — genre expansion

## 📢 Topic Expansion

→ Climate & Environment
→ Crypto & Web3
→ Finance & Markets (daily rates, indices)
→ Football / Premier League edition
→ Local news by city (London, Paris, NYC...)

## 🔄 Format Iterations

→ Weekly Recap — Sunday best-of (10 min)
→ Breaking News — instant alert song (<5 min)
→ Collaborative beats — vote on today's top story
→ Remixes — same news, 3 different genres
→ Duet mode — two AI voices debate a topic

## ⬆️ Quality Upgrades

→ Suno API → highest vocal realism on the market
→ Voice selection — choose male/female/accent
→ Custom voice cloning (B2B: brand voice)
→ Lyric sync display — scrolling lyrics like Spotify
→ Music video mode — auto-generated visuals

Each iteration = new combo keys = new cached content = new reasons to return daily. The format is infinitely expandable with zero marginal content cost.

THE ASK

# Raising £1M–£1.5M

Pre-Seed SAFE · £8–12M post-money valuation cap

**01** 10,000 → 50,000 MAUs in 12 months via creator + social strategy

**02** First 5 brand beat pilots generating native ad revenue

**03** iOS/Android apps + B2B licensing conversations — seed-ready at 12 months

*"Your daily news, in a hit song."*

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